

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1054

By Clemmons

A RESOLUTION to commend Representative Johnny Shaw for his honorable and distinguished service to the people of Tennessee as a member of the House of Representatives.

WHEREAS, it is most appropriate that the members of this General Assembly should honor those fellow legislators who have performed their duties with the utmost integrity and whose efforts during their time in office have been dedicated to providing thoughtful and exemplary service to their districts and to this great State; and

WHEREAS, Representative Johnny Shaw of Bolivar is one such distinguished public servant, who has served both his constituency and this legislative body with honor and ability; and

WHEREAS, during his tenure on Capitol Hill, Representative Shaw has been a highly influential figure in the political, social, and civic life of Hardeman, Haywood, and Madison counties, and he has served his constituents in numerous capacities, always working diligently at his elected duties and expending the necessary effort to understand the opposing sides of complex issues; and

WHEREAS, Johnny Shaw has distinguished himself as a public-spirited citizen of the highest order and as an exceptional asset to the good people of the 80th House District, whom he has represented as a member of the 102nd, 103rd, 104th, 105th, 106th, 107th, 108th, 109th, 110th, 111th, 112th, 113th, and 114th General Assemblies; and

WHEREAS, throughout his service, Representative Shaw has been prominent as a dedicated and well-informed legislator who always votes his conscience; and

WHEREAS, an active and dynamic participant in the legislative process during his time in the General Assembly, Representative Shaw has rendered sterling leadership as chair of the

Tennessee Legislative Black Caucus and as secretary of the House Agriculture Committee and the House Finance, Ways and Means Committee; and

WHEREAS, Representative Shaw has served estimably as a member of the House Finance, Ways and Means Committee, the House Finance, Ways and Means Appropriations Subcommittee, the House Finance, Ways and Means Subcommittee, the House Agriculture Committee, the House Agriculture and Natural Resources Committee, the House Agriculture and Natural Resources Subcommittee, the House Children and Family Affairs Committee, the House Family Justice Subcommittee, the House Domestic Relations Subcommittee, the House Budget Subcommittee, the House State Government Committee, the House State Government Subcommittee, the House Ethics Committee, the House Elections and Campaign Finance Subcommittee, the House Local Government Committee, the House Calendar and Rules Committee, the House Select Committee on Rules, the House State Committee, the House Public Service and Employees Subcommittee, the House General Subcommittee of Agriculture, the House General Subcommittee of Finance, Ways and Means, the Joint Pensions and Insurance Committee, the Joint Council on Pensions and Insurance Committee, and the Joint Fiscal Review Committee; and

WHEREAS, he also served as a member of the House Calendar and Rules Committee and the House Finance, Ways and Means Committee of the Second Extraordinary Session of the 111th General Assembly; the House Finance, Ways and Means Committee of the Second Extraordinary Session of the 112th General Assembly; the House Calendar and Rules Committee and the House Finance, Ways and Means Committee of the Third Extraordinary Session of the 112th General Assembly; the House Agriculture and Natural Resources Committee, the House Agriculture and Natural Resources Subcommittee, the House Local Government Committee, and the House Finance, Ways and Means Subcommittee of the First Extraordinary Session of the 113th General Assembly; and the House Government Operations Committee and the House Transportation Committee of the First Extraordinary Session of the 114th General Assembly; and

WHEREAS, beyond his legislative duties, Representative Shaw has remained deeply engaged in civic and charitable life, serving as a founding member of the Shaw Singers; a member of the Rotary Club of Bolivar, 100 Black Men, the Rural West Tennessee Caucus, the Gathering of Men missionary organization, the Code Red Ministers Coalition of West Tennessee, the Hardeman County Chamber of Commerce, and the Tennessee Association of Broadcasters; a lifetime member of the NAACP; an Alzheimer's Tennessee advocate; and a Commission on Aging advocate; and

WHEREAS, his community leadership has also included service as chair of the Mayor's Character First Program in Brownsville, member of the West Tennessee River Basin Authority Board, board chair of the Western Mental Health Institute, member and vice chair of the Board of Directors of Community Rehabilitation Agencies of Tennessee, steering committee chair of TAKE ONE (Offender Support Program), member of the West Tennessee Public Broadcast Board of Directors, and Hardeman County Commissioner; and

WHEREAS, Representative Shaw has been recognized with numerous honors and distinctions for his leadership and service, including the West Tennessee Black Business Association Chairman's Award, Legislator of the Year from the Tennessee Development District Association, the Jackson Affordable Housing Jo Helen Imani Award, the William Henry Miles Outstanding Community Service Award, the West Tennessee African American Entrepreneurs C.A. Rawls Bridge Builder Award, the Big Brothers Big Sisters Appreciation and Service Award, the Tennessee Association of Broadcasters Distinguished Service Award, the Southeast Association of Area Agencies on Aging's Impact Award, and Legislator of the Year from the NBCSL Corporate Roundtable Benjamin Ruffin Award; and

WHEREAS, additional distinctions awarded to Representative Shaw include recognition as a Media History Maker by The HistoryMakers, Legislator of the Year from the Tennessee Forestry Association, and Legislator of the Year from the Southwest Tennessee Development District, in addition to his receipt of the Presidential Award for Meritorious Service from the

Tennessee Education Association and The North Star Award from the Hardeman County Commission for Black History; and

WHEREAS, he was further honored by the designation of a portion of Highway 64 as the "Representative Johnny W. Shaw Highway" by the Hardeman County Commission, recognition as the Legislator of the Year from the Tennessee Veterinary Medical Association and as a USDA Rural Development Tennessee State Black History Month Honoree, and receipt of the NFIB Guardian of Small Business Award; and

WHEREAS, born on January 5, 1942, in Laconia, Johnny Shaw attended the American Baptist Theological Seminary in Nashville, where he studied theology, and pursued a distinguished career in broadcasting beginning in the 1960s at WBOL-AM in Bolivar, where he became the station's first African American staff announcer and later served as program director, assistant manager, and general manager; and

WHEREAS, in 1987, Representative Shaw and his wife, Opal, founded Shaw Broadcasting Company, LLC, which acquired WBOL-AM and later established WOJG-FM in Bolivar; he also faithfully served as a minister of Saint John Missionary Baptist Church in Stanton for many years; and

WHEREAS, throughout his outstanding career as a public servant, Representative Johnny Shaw has worked tirelessly on behalf of his constituents, bringing to his office an honorable bearing and the traditional values of hard work and common sense; and

WHEREAS, Representative Shaw is wholly committed to the noble precepts of public service that have earned Tennessee recognition as the Volunteer State, and he should be specially recognized for his exemplary tenure in the General Assembly; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we hereby honor Representative Johnny Shaw for his meritorious service to Tennessee as a member of the House of Representatives, commend him for his countless

contributions and many good works in service of the citizens of 80th House District, and extend to him our best wishes for much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.